Students Studying in The United States

RENEWING YOUR F-1/J-1 VISA

CURRENT TRAVEL RECOMMENDATIONS

Prior to making plans to travel outside of the U.S., all current students and alumni on OPT/STEM/AT should review OGS' recommendations for travel.

Current Travel Recommendations (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/current-travel-rec

F-1/J-1 VISA EXPIRATION: WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

Depending on the length of your academic program, your F-1/J-1 visa may expire while you are still enrolled at Northeastern University, or while you are working on Post-

Completion OPT/AT. It is important to understand what an expired visa does and does not affect.

- **Your F-1/J-1 visa is an entry document, not a status document.** It must be valid when you enter the U.S., but does not determine your eligibility to remain.
- Your visa may expire during your time at Northeastern. This has no impact on your legal status or your ability to complete your degree.
- As long as you are maintaining your F-1/J-1 status and have a valid I-20/DS-2019, you may remain in the U.S. after your visa expires.
- You only need to renew your visa if you plan to travel internationally and your visa has expired, whether during your academic program, OPT/STEM Extension, or Academic Training period.
- It is not recommended to travel solely for the purpose of visa renewal, as processing delays could prevent you from returning to campus in time to maintain full-time, on-ground enrollment.

If you do need to renew your visa, please refer to the guidance below. Note that visa renewal is discretionary and carries some risk of delay or denial.

VISA RENEWAL PROCESS

+ Important Note about Visa Renewals

+ Scheduling the Visa Renewal Appointment

+ Recommended Documents for Current Students/Alumni

+ Additional Documents for F-1 Students on Post-OPT/STEM Extension

+ Additional Documents for J-1 Students on Academic Training

+ Online Presence and Social Media Review

VISA APPLICATION OUTCOMES

Please note that if you are a current student and your attempt to renew your visa prevents you from returning to the U.S. to resume classes, you may be advised to seek a leave of absence.

+ **Approval**

+ **Denials**

+ **Administrative Processing**

REPLACING A LOST OR STOLEN F-1/J-1 VISA

It is recommended that F-1/J-1 students make photocopies of all their immigration documents (including passport and F-1/J-1 visa). If your passport containing the F-1/J-1 visa is lost or stolen, please file a police report immediately by either going to a local police station or contacting NUPD (https://nupd.northeastern.edu/contact-us/how-to-reach-nupd/). You should then report your passport/visa lost or stolen to the local Embassy/Consular section of your country of citizenship in the U.S., requesting a new passport (if you have no other valid passport) and to the U.S. Embassy/Consular section which issued your F-1/J-1 visa originally.

It is not possible to replace a lost or stolen F-1/J-1 visa in the U.S. However, if you still have a valid passport or have submitted a request to replace your passport, and you have a valid I-20/DS-2019, you may remain in the U.S. even with the lost F-1/J-1 visa. If you travel internationally, you will need to renew the F-1/J-1 visa at a U.S. Embassy/Consulate abroad to return to the U.S. When applying for the replacement visa, you will need to provide a copy of the police report and written documentation about the loss of your passport and visa.

Please see the U.S. Department of State website (https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/us-visas/visa-information-resources/lost-stolen-visas.html) for more guidance.

TRAVEL TO CANADA, MEXICO, OR U.S. ADJACENT ISLANDS

If you travel to Canada, Mexico, or one of the islands adjacent (https://www.ice.gov/sevis/travel) to the U.S. (other than Cuba) for less than thirty days with your valid passport, a valid form I-20 or form DS-2019, and your most recent form I-94 (https://i94.cbp.dhs.gov/I94/#/home), you may be eligible to travel with an expired F or J visa. This process is known as automatic visa revalidation (https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/us-visas/visa-information-resources/visa-expiration-date/auto-revalidate.html#ExternalPopup). However, you must meet certain conditions in order to be eligible for automatic visa revalidation. Please visit the U.S. Customs and Border Protection (https://cbpcomplaints.cbp.gov/s/article/Article-1446?language=en_US) and the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (https://www.ice.gov/sevis/travel) for more information on eligibility.

RELATED ARTICLES:

Paying the I-901 SEVIS Fee (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/new-students/paying-sevis-fee/)

Obtaining I-94 (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/new-students/arrival/obtaining-i-94/)

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OFFICE HOURS

Monday-Friday: 8:30a.m.-5:00p.m.
(Note: We are closed on Tuesdays from 3:00pm – 4:00pm for all staff training and meeting).
Phone Hours:

Monday-Friday: 8:30a.m.–4:30p.m. ET

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